

INVESTORS FORUM

DAY 01

CRISIS 01 – A New Chapter in Pakistan– China Cooperation

A meeting took place between Pakistan and China's EV industry, where it was agreed that China would make significant investments in Pakistan's growing EV market. The development could strengthen economic cooperation between the two countries, with potential improvements to the CPEC agreement.

There are also increasing chances of Pakistan becoming a part of BRICS, adding further significance to the country's growing economic and diplomatic ties.

CRISIS 02 – Rising Oil Prices Trigger Unrest

Due to increasing global oil prices, the Pakistani government raised domestic oil prices despite widespread public opposition. The decision placed further pressure on consumers and businesses, contributing to growing frustration across the country.

This led to a series of widespread riots, with the situation escalating further following the death of the owner of Stylers. The incident added to the uncertainty surrounding the country's economic and social conditions.

CRISIS 03 – Gul Plaza Destroyed Amid Widespread Riots

The riots continued to spread throughout the city, intensifying unrest and disruption across several areas. Amid the ongoing situation, a fire broke out at Gul Plaza, leaving the entire building in ruins.

The incident caused major losses for the traders and businesses operating within the plaza, further worsening the economic impact of the unrest.

CRISIS 04 – Government Steps In to Support Affected Traders

A meeting was held between Pakistan's government and the Trade Union, where an agreement was finalised to support traders adversely affected by the riots, particularly those affected by the Gul Plaza incident.

Under the agreement, the government would assist by constructing new infrastructure while also promising to reduce taxes on petrol. These measures hinted at potential improvements in economic stability and support for the affected business community.

CRISIS 05 – Attack on Chinese Delegation Raises Tensions

A delegation arriving from China to Pakistan for further talks concerning the agreement was attacked in a bomb blast. The incident resulted in the deaths of five Chinese delegates along with two Pakistani officials.

The attack created further uncertainty surrounding the ongoing discussions between Pakistan and China and raised concerns over the future of their economic cooperation.

DAY 02

CRISIS 01 – Pakistan Turns Towards Western Trade Partners

Amid an overall decline in the country's economic condition, the PM led a delegation to Britain to sign a trade agreement with Britain and the USA. The agreement would result in investment flowing into Pakistan's infrastructure and renewable and non-renewable energy sectors, along with increased exports of Pakistani textiles and medical and surgical instruments.

However, Bloomberg suggested that Pakistan-China relations could worsen following these developments, further reducing the prospects of Pakistan joining BRICS.

CRISIS 02 – PM Dismisses Reports of Worsening China Relations

The PM intervened and dismissed the rumours regarding worsening Pakistan–China relations as false. The government clarified that normal investment from China would continue despite the recent developments. The statement helped reassure that Pakistan’s economic cooperation with China would remain intact, despite the growing uncertainty surrounding the country’s international trade and investment relationships.

CRISIS 03 – Provincial Elections Create Political Uncertainty

Provincial elections took place across Pakistan, resulting in the previously elected party losing in its traditional stronghold. The unexpected outcome created uncertainty surrounding the country's political direction and the stability of the newly elected government.

Widespread rumours of electoral rigging further intensified the situation, raising concerns among the public and international allies. The resulting political uncertainty negatively affected Pakistan's relations with its allies and contributed to a decline in the inflow of foreign investment.

CRISIS 04 – New Government Announces Economic Measures

The newly elected government announced plans to provide subsidies to the petrol industry while attracting new investment into the country. It also committed to improving overall infrastructure, with a focus on strengthening key areas of the economy.

Increased efforts towards the development of the public sector were expected to support improvements across multiple sectors. These measures signalled the government's intention to promote economic stability and encourage further investment in Pakistan.